Lab 07 — Mini Capstone: Your Own Short Film, Idea to Upload

Course: Agentic AI for Video Creation (C436)

Day 2 · Topic 3 · about 70 minutes · slides 153–159

Agent: Claude Desktop + Higgsfield + LahLah Video — all skills, platform-publish

Features: Your own idea · a new project · the full skill chain · references as Elements · low-res drafts on a hard budget · LahLah Video · platform-publish · private upload · AI label · adoption plan

The story so far

Priya hands you the studio for an hour: make any short film you like (a micro-drama, an ad, a music clip, a family story) from idea to a private upload, then write the plan that makes this way of working stick. Ah Ma's Love Letter is the worked example.

Your goal

Prove you can run the whole pipeline on a story of your own: approve the board, generate on a budget, cut, check, publish privately with the AI label on, and plan the adoption with your own numbers.

You'll produce

Project "Capstone – [FILM TITLE]"; your film exported as EP02_v1.mp4; a private or draft upload with the AI label on; an adoption plan

What is in this folder

- `assets/short-film-brief-template.pdf`
- `assets/project-capstone-setup.pdf`
- `assets/publish-checklist.pdf`
- `assets/adoption-plan-template.pdf`
- `assets/sample/short-film-brief.pdf`
- `assets/sample/upload-plan.pdf`
- `assets/sample/adoption-plan.pdf`
- `assets/optional/episode-02-brief.pdf`
- `prompts.html` — open in a browser; one click copies each prompt into Claude
- `prompts.pdf` — the same prompts, printable
- `evidence/checklist.pdf` — what to capture as proof
- `../prompt-builder.html` — build your own prompt for any stage, genre and platform

Why each step matters

- This lab is the whole course in one hour on a story you chose: idea, prompt, story, storyboard, script, Higgsfield, edit, review, publish. The skills carry the know-how, so each step is one prompt.
- Keep it small. Three to five shots of 5 seconds, one location, two characters at most. Ah Ma's Love Letter is four shots, three references and about 14 credits.
- Export your film as EP02_v1.mp4 and keep the screenshot of the private upload settings with the AI label on.
- platform-publish prepares everything a platform asks for: export settings, title, description, hashtags, a thumbnail prompt and the AI disclosure. It never posts without your explicit yes.
- Adopting a new technology means people use it well, not that it is installed. Measure a baseline, run a small pilot, train, govern (credit caps, low-res drafts before 1080p, approval gates, the compliance skill), then decide with numbers.

Step by step

1. **Pitch your film** — Any story you like, 20-45 seconds, 3-5 shots, fictional people only. Fill short-film-brief-template.pdf (see the Ah Ma sample).
2. **New project** — Create "Capstone – [FILM TITLE]" from project-capstone-setup.pdf; add your brief and your standards.
3. **Idea to approved board** — Prompt A chains storytelling and storyboard: three loglines, then the brief, asset bible and board. Approve it.
4. **Cast, then shoot** — Prompt B: references saved as Elements, low-res drafts with dialogue in quotes, upgrade the keepers, hard budget.
5. **Cut and export** — Open lahlah-edit.json in LahLah Video; captions, music under the voices, end card, AI label; export EP02_v1.mp4.
6. **Check, publish privately, plan** — Run kopi-compliance-review, then Prompt C (platform-publish, Private or draft) and Prompt D (adoption plan).

The prompts

PROMPT A — your idea to an approved storyboard

> Use the storytelling skill, then the storyboard skill.
>
> My short film: [ONE-LINE IDEA]. Genre [GENRE], for
> [PLATFORM], 9:16, [LENGTH: 20-45] seconds, [3-5] shots,
> fictional characters only: [WHO].
>
> Give me three loglines and stop. After I pick one, write the
> brief, the asset bible (characters, location, props) and the
> storyboard artifact marked DRAFT, then stop for my approval.

PROMPT B — cast, then shoot on a hard budget

> Use the video-script skill on the approved storyboard, then
> the higgsfield-video skill.
>
> 1. References first: one 9:16 still per character, location
> and key prop; save the ones I approve as Elements.

> 2. Draft every shot at 480p on Seedance 2.0 Mini, sound on; put each spoken line in quotes with the speaker named.
> 3. Upgrade to 1080p only the drafts I approve.
>
> Hard limit: [BUDGET] credits in total; ask before each batch. Higgsfield project: "Capstone – [FILM TITLE]". Finish with the status table, download links, lahlah-edit.json (fps = the clips' frame rate) and captions.srt.

PROMPT C — publish privately (platform-publish skill)

> Use the platform-publish skill for EP02_v1 ("[FILM TITLE]") on [PLATFORM].
>
> Give me: export settings, a title under 60 characters, a description with the AI disclosure, five hashtags, a thumbnail prompt, and the exact clicks to switch on the AI-content label. The upload stays Private (YouTube) or a draft (TikTok). Do not publish anything yourself.

PROMPT D — adoption plan

> Write an adoption plan for running Kopi & Coins on Claude, Higgsfield and LahLah Video.
>
> Use my numbers: Episode 1 took [HOURS] hours and [CREDITS] credits; my capstone film took [HOURS] hours and [CREDITS] credits; low-res drafting saved about [SAVED] credits.
>
> Sections: baseline; a 4-week pilot (scope, team); at least four metrics with targets; training and support; governance (credit caps, low-res-first rule, approval gates, the compliance skill, AI labels, who may publish); the decision point to scale, adjust or stop.

Check your work

- □ Your capstone project holds the brief, the approved storyboard and the approved script.
- □ References saved as Elements; every shot drafted low-res and the keepers upgraded within budget.
- □ EP02_v1.mp4 exported: your film, 9:16, captions on, AI label on the end card.
- □ The compliance review shows no high-risk findings.
- □ A screenshot shows the private or draft upload with the AI label switched on.
- □ The adoption plan has a baseline, a pilot, four metrics with targets, governance and a decision point.

If it goes wrong

- **Out of credits** — Keep the low-res drafts and use the mock clips from Lab 5 for missing shots; the pipeline is the evidence.

- **Stuck for an idea** — Remake a family memory, a product you love, or a 20-second twist on a proverb. Or make Episode 2 of Kopi & Coins.
- **No TikTok or YouTube account** — Show the upload plan from Prompt C and a screenshot of the settings page; do not create accounts in class.

Stretch

- Ask Claude to turn your film into episode 1 of a series: three more loglines and a credit budget per episode.

> **Small and finished beats big and broken. Four good shots and a clean upload are the capstone.**

Next

You have finished the labs. Keep your evidence: it is your portfolio from the course.

Safety

Use only this lab's fictitious characters and data and your own accounts. Never paste an API key, password or personal data into a prompt, a file you share or a screenshot. Nothing is uploaded publicly; upload plans stay private until a person approves.